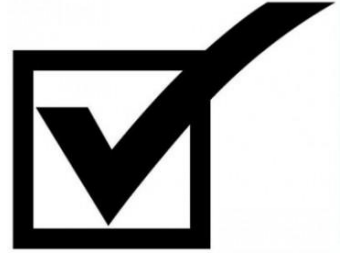


**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS**
of **AMERICA**
Giving Purpose to Potential



FINANCIAL ANALYST TEAM (150)

NATIONALS 2025 FINALS

GENERAL GUIDELINES

1. **Formulate Questions:** As a team of judges, create two to three questions to ask at the end of each presentation. *Make sure to ask the same questions to every team.*
2. **Presentation Details:**
 - **Setup Time:** Teams have up to 3 minutes to set up.
 - **Presentation Time:** Each team has up to 10 minutes to present, followed by up to 10 minutes for judges' questions.
 - **Completion:** Excuse the teams after the judges' questions are finished.
3. **Judging Rules:**
 - **No Ties:** There can be no ties in the top 10 teams. Judges are responsible for breaking any ties.
 - **Ranking:** The administrator will fill out the ranking sheet before dismissing the judges.
4. **Post-Presentation:**
5. **Materials:** Give all Judges' Rating Sheets, Judge Evaluation Sheets, and contest materials to the administrator.
6. **Audience:** No audience is allowed in the contest room.

INITIAL CASE STUDY TOPIC

Ellie has always had a passion for gold jewelry and has decided to turn her hobby into a small business. For the past several years, Ellie has been selling her gold jewelry at trade shows and online. Ellie has received interest from several partners who want to place large orders and carry her products as part of their permanent collections. Ellie has been operating her business as a hobby but has decided that now is the time to create a small business and operate it full-time. Ellie does not know much about the different types of business organizations and would like your advice on what type of business she should start. Ellie will be investing \$100,000 of her own money into the business, in addition to contributing equipment worth \$400,000. Ellie estimates that this equipment still has 10 years of life left and estimates that she will be able to sell it for \$40,000 at the end of that time. Ellie has also secured a \$500,000 loan from First Bank with an annual interest rate of 5% for 10 years.

Based on last year's prices and her current orders, Ellie has created the following materials budget for the next six months. She normally marks up her jewelry at 32% of the price of the gold. Ellie does not keep any inventory of gold on hand since she is a made-to-order business.

Month 1	\$1,405
Month 2	1,240
Month 3	1,318
Month 4	1,390
Month 5	1,308
Month 6	1,230

Ellie estimates her other expenses to be as follows for the next six months.

Accountant	\$2,500
Marketing	5,000
Packaging	2,000
Shipping	3,000
Insurance	12,000
Rent	12,000
Supplies	3,000
Utilities	4,000

Ellie is currently owed \$6,000 from previous orders; 10% of the amount owed to Ellie is over 30 days past due.

As Ellie embarks on this entrepreneurial journey, she seeks advice on several critical aspects of starting and managing her business: the type of business entity to form, the inventory valuation method to use, the depreciation method to adopt, and the accounting for accounts receivables. Ellie has asked you to prepare a recommendation for these questions, as well as others that she has not considered, as well as pro forma financials to help her get her business off the ground.

ADDITIONAL SCENARIO FOR PRELIMS

Market Competition: A new competitor has entered the market, offering similar gold jewelry at a lower price point. This development poses a significant challenge to Ellie's market share and requires her to reassess her competitive positioning. Ellie must evaluate how this competition impacts her pricing strategy, value proposition, and overall market strategy. She will need to explore potential responses, such as differentiating her products, enhancing customer service, or adjusting her marketing approach, to effectively compete and maintain her business's profitability.

POTENTIAL JUDGE'S QUESTIONS

1. How should Ellie conduct a detailed competitive analysis to understand the strengths and weaknesses of the new competitor, and what insights should she gather to inform her response?
2. In light of the new competitor's lower price point, how can Ellie reassess and adjust her pricing strategy to remain competitive while maintaining profitability?
3. What steps can Ellie take to strengthen and clearly communicate her value proposition to customers, ensuring they perceive the benefits of her products despite the lower-priced competition?
4. What specific strategies can Ellie implement to differentiate her products from those of the new competitor, and how can she leverage these differentiators to attract and retain customers?
5. How should Ellie modify her marketing approach to address the increased competition and effectively promote her brand's unique strengths and benefits?
6. What strategies should Ellie employ to enhance customer loyalty and retention in the face of increased competition, and how can she build stronger relationships with her existing customers?